Making of Indian Constitution

The members of Constituent Assembly drafted the Indian Constitution. The Constituent Assembly held its first meeting on 9th December 1946 and re-assembled after partition of Pakistan as Constituent Assembly for the remaining India on 14th August 1947. The members of the Provincial Legislative Assemblies indirectly elected the members of the Constitutent Assembly.

The Constituent Assembly was composed of members along the lines suggested by the plan proposed by the Committee of the British Cabinet, also known as the Cabinet Mission.



(February 1948: some members of the Drafting Committee of the Constituent Assembly of India: (seated from left) N. Madhava Rao, Saiyid Muhammad Saadulla, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar, Sir Alladi Krishnaswamy Ayyar and Sir B. N. Rao. Also in the Picture are (Standing from Left) S.N. Mukherjee. Jugal Kishore Khanna and Kewal Krishnan)

According to this plan provinces and princely states or group of states were allotted seats proportional to their respective population roughly in the ratio of 1:1 million. The provinces were to elect 292 members while the princely states were to send a minimum of 93 seats.

The seats of each province were distributed among three main communities, namely, the Hindus, Muslims, and Sikhs, in proportion to their respective populations in their province.

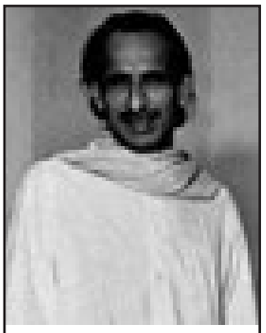
Members of each community in the Provisional Legislative Assembly elected their representatives by the method of proportional representation with a single transferable vote.



The method of selection of representatives of Princely States was to be determined by the princely states themselves.

The Composition of the Constituent Assembly

Two hundred eighty-four members were present on 26th November 1949 and appended their signature to the Constitution as finally passed.



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